

cheapest way to create a legal structure.

It was also one of the worst ways to do this.

Any good lawyer will tell you that a partnership structure does not protect the founders if the venture fails. The better way to do this is to set up a limited liability corporation (LLC). Different state regulations and tax rates affect different planning needs, and these might lead savvy founders to another structure—an S Corp. or C Corp.—that best fit their specific needs.

All these variables should be understood and discussed in terms of tax consequences and personal liabilities. A good attorney who can explain this—and draw up proper incorporation documents—is invaluable.

Who you work with and what you do is important to your happiness and life satisfaction

Not to get all Zen on you, but starting a new firm means you are going to be spending a lot of time working with the same people day in, day out. After your spouse, it's the most intimate relationship most people have. I am fortunate to work with a brilliant group of “crazy ones, who think different,” are fun to be around and keep things moving forward in fascinating ways.

Making sure you are compatible with your fellow workers makes a big difference in your life satisfaction. Had Wayne stayed, he very well could have ended up rich but miserable.

Have a plan

Have a well-thought-out (business/financial/investing) plan. Failing to plan pretty much guarantees future failure.

The early days of Apple were pretty ad hoc. It seems as if little planning was done and that the partners were not on the same page in terms of priorities and focus. Of course the initial partnership did not survive.